Cirque, Aretes, Matterhorn, U-shaped valley, Hanging valley, Fiords etc., Most of these glacial features are predominantly seen in countries like Switzerland, Norway etc.,

Cirque

The glacier erodes the steep side walls of the mountain and forms a **bowl-shaped armchair like depression**, it is termed as Cirque.

Arete

Aretes are narrow ridges formed when two cirque walls joined together back to back, and forms narrow knife like ridges.

Pyramidal Peak

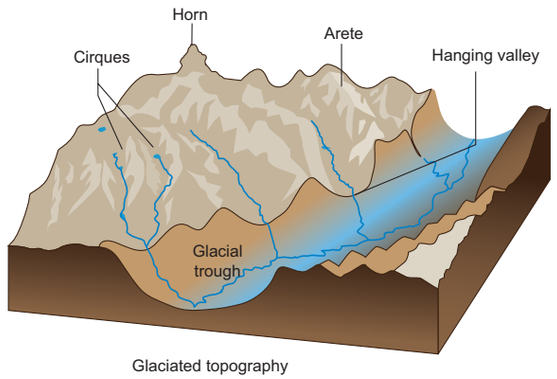
The pyramidal peaks formed when three or more cirques meet together (eg) **Matterhorns.**

U-Shaped Valley

When the glacier moves down along a river valley, the valley further gets eroded deep and wide to form a 'U' shaped valley.

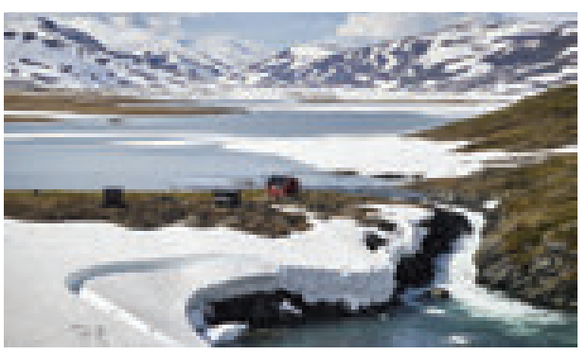
Hanging Valley

These are valleys eroded by tributary glacier and that hangs over the main valley.



Glaciated topography

Fjord



Fjords are glacial valleys that are partly submerged in the sea.

Depositional Landforms of glacier

After getting eroded, fragments of rocks and boulders along with dirt form **glacial debris**. Glacial debris gets deposited in the low lying areas and form depositional features like **moraines, drumlins, eskers, kames and outwash plains**.

Moraine

1. Materials deposited by Glaciers is called Moraines.
2. Based on the location, they are classifed into Ground moraine, Terminal moraine and Lateral moraine.



Drumlin(Basket of Egg Topography)

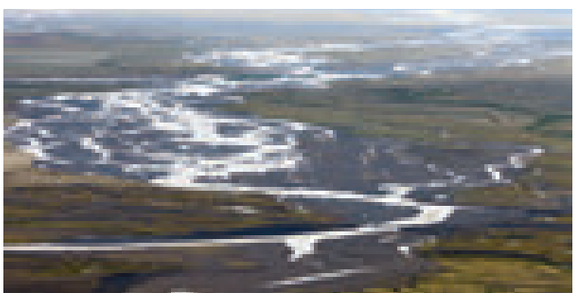
Drumlins are deposits of glacial moraines that resemble giant inverted teaspoons or half cut eggs.

Esker

Long narrow ridges composed of boulders gravel and sand deposited by streams of melting water which run parallel to a glacier are called eskers.

Outwash Plain

An outwash plain consists of glacial sediments deposited by the melting ice at the terminus of a glacier. It appears as an extensive accumulation of sand, gravel and silt.



TN_GOVT_IX_Std_Geography_Ch02.indd 174 02-04-2019 13:06:45